

ELENA KORCHMINA

University of Bologna

Department of Economics

Italy

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Citizenship: Russian

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Academic Positions

- 2024- University of Bologna, Assistant Professor
- 2022- 2024 University of Southern Denmark, Department of Economics, Assistant Professor
- 2021- 2022 University of Southern Denmark, Department of Economics, Marie Skłodowska-Curie Fellow.
- 2020 – 2021 Higher School of Economics (Moscow), History Department, Assistant Professor.
- 2017 – 2020 New York University Abu Dhabi (UAE), Social Science Division, Postdoctoral Research Associate.
- 2019 Nuffield College, Oxford (UK), Academic Visitor.
- 2014 – 2020 Higher School of Economics (Moscow), Senior Research Associate.
- 2014 – 2015 Higher School of Economics (Moscow), Acting Director of Center for History Sources.
- 2012 – 2013 Russian Presidential Academy of National Economy and Public Administration (Moscow), Postdoc Karamzin Fellow.

Education

- 2010, October Ph.D. in Russian History (*Kandidat nauk* in Russian). Vladimir State Humanitarian University. Dissertation topic: “Noble self-government in the first half of the 19th century. The case of Ryazan province”.
- 1999 – 2002 BA in Law (cum laude), Ryazan branch of Moscow Academy of Economy and Law.
- 1995 – 2000 MA in History (cum laude), Ryazan State Pedagogical University.

Research Interests

Economic History of Early Modern Europe, Russian Political and Social History, Social History of Eastern Europe, Fiscal Sociology, History of European Elites, Gender Studies, Living Standards in Historical Perspective.

Publications in English-Language Peer-reviewed Journals

1. Catching-up and falling behind: Russian economic growth, 1690s-1880s”, With S. Broadberry. Accepted, *Journal of Economic History*, 2024, Vol. 84, No. 4.

2. Should I stay or should I go? Living standards of serfs and peasants in 18th century Moscow, *Rivista di storia economica. Italian Review of Economic History*, accepted
3. Peer Pressure: The Puzzle of Tax Compliance of Aristocrats in Early Nineteenth-Century Moscow, *The Economic History Review*, 2022, Vol. 75, issue 3, pp. 779-800.
4. 'Luxury beyond morals': the rise and transformation of the concept in 18th century Russia. *The Journal of the History of Economic Thought*, 2022, p. 1-19. With M. Kiselev
5. Denmark and Russia: What can we learn from the historical comparison of two great Arctic agricultural empires? *Russian Journal of Economics*, 2021. No. 7 (2). With P. Sharp
6. Cattle pasturing as a traditional form of forest use and conflicts between peasants and forestry administration in the long nineteenth century (The case of Białowieża Forest), *Global Environment*, 2020, Vol. 13. No. 3. P. 525-554. With A. Fedotova.
7. Extralegal payments to state officials in Russia, 1750s–1830s: assessing the burden of corruption, *The Economic History Review*, 2019, 1 (Vol. 72), pp. 156 - 181. With I. Fedyukin.
 - listed within the best 35 papers among published papers for 3 years in Higher School of Economics.
8. Karamzin and Money, *Cahiers du Monde Russe*, 2018, 1. (Vol. 59), pp. 117-140. with A. Zorin
9. Conceptualising the Notion of “Profit” among the Russian Nobility (Second Half of the 18th – First Half of the 19th Centuries), *Quaestio Rossica*, 2018, 4 (Vol. 6), pp. 1144–59.

Working Papers

1. Income and its distribution under serfdom: Economic inequality in early 19th century Russia in a global perspective. With M. Malinowski. R&R in Journal of Economic History
2. Institutions in Russia under the Ancient Regime (1725-1861): Taxation, Property, and Elections.
3. Wealth, inequality, and sex: the changes in female and male wealth and their consequences for the governance of the Russian Empire from 1700s to 1850s. EHES Working Paper, No. 243, November 2023

Work in Progress

1. Living standards in Russia in regional and historical perspective.
2. A new Russian price index for the 19th century. With T. Valetov and R. Konchakov
3. The transfer of knowledge under the autocracy. How did Danish entrepreneurs manage to get Russian money?
4. Minority Entrepreneurs: The Industrial Development of the Russian Empire in the 19th century with Marvin Suisse.

Book Project

The invention of patriarchy in Russia: How the Enlightenment suppressed the economic rights of Russian women?

Publications in Russian-Language Peer-reviewed Journals

1. Daily wages of the construction labourers and prices in Moscow and Tobolsk in the 18th century, *Ural Historical Journal*, 2020, 1.
2. The structure of noble property of the Moscow gentry in 1812, *Istoriya (History)*, 2020, Vol. 3. with R. Konchakov.
3. “Don’t give bribes in honour”: how gifts became bribes in Post-Petrine Russia, *Rossiiskaia istoria (Russian History)*, 2015, 2.
4. “To take more ladies’ votes”: the participation of women in noble elections in Russia in the first half of the 19th century, *Rossiiskaia istoria (Russian History)*, 2015, 6.
5. “Many millions of Russian state money are unknown”: poll tax arrears of the 1720-1760s”, *Rossiiskaia istoria (Russian History)*, 2013, 5.
6. Relocation of the poorest nobility from Ryazan to Simbirsk region in the 1840-1850s (in Russian), *Izvestija Samarskogo nauchnogo centra Rossijskoj Akademii Nauk*, 2010, vol. 12, 6 (38).

Book Chapters

1. What Could the Empress Know About Her Money? Russian Poll Tax Revenues in the Eighteenth Century, in *Information and Empire: Mechanisms of Communication in Russia, 1600–1850*. Ed. by S. Franklin and K. Bowers, Cambridge, UK: Open Book Publishers, 2017, pp. 287-310.
2. The Practice of Personal Finance and the Problem of Debt among the Noble Elite in Eighteenth-Century Russia, in *The Europeanized Elite in Russia, 1762-1825: Public Role and Subjective Self*. Ed. by A. Zorin, A. Schönle, and A. Evstratov. NIU Press, 2016, pp. 162-192.
3. Collecting Poll Tax in Mid-Eighteenth Century: Assessing the Effectiveness of Russian State Apparatus in Historical Perspective, (in Russian), *Ekonomicheskaja istorija: Ezhegodnik*, 2013. Moscow, 2014. With I. Fedyukin
4. The beginning of the 19th century in Russian provinces: the perception of contemporaries, (in Russian) in *Izobretenie veka. Problemy i modeli vremeni v Rossii i Evrope XIX stoletija*. Moscow, 2013.

Grants

2022	Invited to the Interview for ERC consolidator grant. Demythologizing The Russian Empire: A Quantitative Analysis Of Serfdom, Patriarchy, And Military Glory
2022	Co-Investigator. <i>Carlsberg</i> Infrastructure grant (22,500 euros), University of Southern Denmark (Denmark).
2021 - 2023	Main Investigator. Marie Skłodowska-Curie fellowship of EU (score: 100.0), University of Southern Denmark (Denmark).
2020 - 2021	Main Investigator. Project: Living Standards in Pre-Industrial Russia. (9,000 \$), <i>Higher School of Economics (Russia)</i> .
2020	Main Investigator. Seal of Excellence of Marie Skłodowska-Curie fellowship of EU (score: 89.6), EU.

- 2019 Paulsen Fellow. Project: The Costs of Russian Westernization, *The London School of Economics and Political Science* (UK).
- 2016 - 2019 Leading Research Fellow. Project: Natural Resources in History of Russia: Economic Institutes, Communities of Experts and Infrastructures, *The Russian Science Foundation* (lead Prof. J. Lajus).
- 2013 - 2015 Research fellow. Project: Europeanization of Russian Elite, *The Leverhulme Foundation* (lead Prof. A. Schönle, A. Zorin).
- 2012 - 2013 Karamzin Fellow. Project: The Emergence of Fiscal Military State in Russia, *The Mikhail Prokhorov Foundation* (lead I. Fedyukin).

Awards

- 2022 *European Research Council*, passed to the stage of the interview.
- 2021 *Higher School of Economics*: Reward for contribution to the international reputation of Higher School of Economics.
- 2020 *Higher School of Economics*: Reward for academic work (the quality of international publications).
- 2019 *Higher School of Economics*: Nominated as the Best Teacher in the category of Supervisor.
- 2016 *Higher School of Economics*: Reward for academic work (the quality of publications).
- 2015 *Higher School of Economics*: Reward for academic work (the quality of publications).

Teaching

University of Bologna (Italy)

“Economic History”

University of Southern Denmark (Odense)

“Business History”

Higher School of Economics (Moscow):

“Economic History of the Early Modern and Modern World” (in Russian)

- rated by students as the best course at the History Department, 2021

“Historical demography” (in Russian)

- rated by students as the best course at the History Department, 2020

“Historical Vocabulary (in English), 2020

“Economic History of Russia” (in Russian), 2014 – 2016

“The history of corruption” (in Russian), 2016

New York University Abu Dhabi

Guest lecturer. “State formation in the Middle East in a global perspective” (in English), 2018/2019

Russian Presidential Academy of National Economy and Public Administration (Moscow)

Supervision

- 2020 – 2023 PhD Supervisor of a student at Higher School of Economics (Moscow)
- 2016 – 2021 Supervisor of six BA and MA thesis, two of which were nominated as the best at Higher School of Economics at History Department

Invited talks

- 2024 *Oxford*: Wealth, inequality and sex: the changes in female and male wealth and their consequences for the governance of the Russian Empire from the 1700s to the 1850s.
- 2020 *Paris School of Economics*. Peer-pressure: the puzzle of tax compliance.
- 2018 *Università degli Studi di Milano*. At the workshop: “Nobili in affair patrimonio, investment, innovazioni (Secoli XVIII-XX) Noblemen in Business: Wealth, Investments, Innovation (18th-20th Centuries)”, Milan, Italy.

Presentations at Conferences

- 2023 ASSA, New Orleans, USA
- 2022 Comparative Economics and Policy-making in Transition, London, UK
- 2022 Baltic connections, Jyväskylä, Finland
- 2022 Ninth CEPR Economic History Symposium, Odense, Denmark
- 2022 Annual Economic History Society, Cambridge, UK
- 2021 Workshop on Russian and Soviet Economic History, Chicago, USA.
- 2020 CEPR-NYUAD Workshop on Economic Divergence and Convergence in History, Abu Dhabi, UAE.
- 2019 Summer Workshop in Madison, USA; Annual Economic History Society, Belfast, UK; Workshop “The Economic Elites of Ukraine and Central-Eastern Europe: A Comparative Historical Perspective”, L’viv, Ukraine.
- 2018 The 18th World Economic History Congress, Boston, USA; 10th International Conference on the 50th Anniversary of the Study Group on Eighteenth-Century Russia, Strasbourg, France; the 43rd Annual Economic and Business History Society Conference, Jyväskylä, Finland; the 12th European Social Science History conference, Belfast, UK; CEPR-NYUAD Workshop on Economic Divergence and Convergence in History, Abu Dhabi, UAE.
- 2017 Second World Congress of Comparative Economics, Saint-Petersburg, Russia.
- 2016 the 11th European Social Science History Conference, Valencia, Spain.
- 2015 the 17th World Economic history Congress, Kyoto, Japan; the WEast workshop “Historical sources of development”, Budapest, Hungary.

- 2014 The European Economic History Summer School, Berlin, Germany; “Information Technologies and Transfer in Russia, 1450-1850”, Cambridge, UK. The European Social Science History Conference in Vienna, Austria
- 2012 , Humboldt Colloquium “The Role of Fundamental Sciences in Society”, Moscow, Russia.

Media Engagement

- 2022 On-line lecture: The economic position of women in Russia (in Russian)
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mieBFyPHO5o>
- 2021 Interview about Marie Curie project (In English)
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3f8Hp5jQmxg>
- 2020 On-line lecture: Comparison of Russian and Denmark (in Russian)
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eiQgz0I_qhA
- 2020 Expert for a documentary series: ‘The Nobles’ Money (in Russian)
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tay9snBUHMk>
- 2020 On-line lecture: The peasant household and serfdom in Russia (in Russian)
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=P_BaBljLLIAA&feature=emb_logo
- 2019 Podcast: How people spent money 150 years ago (in Russian)
<https://prishli.me/>
- 2017 Audio lecture: Moscow VS Petersburg (in Russian)
<https://arzamas.academy/materials/1491>
- 2016 On-line course: The Splendor and Misery of the Russian Nobles (in Russian)
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9DbocU-Cn4c>

Other Professional Activities

Referee for: *Cahiers du Monde Russe*, *Economic History Review*, *Scandinavian Economic History Review*, *European Review of Economic History*.

Co-organizer of workshop:

Summer Workshop in the Economic History and Historical Political Economy of Eurasia (Paris, France), 2023

“Understanding Economic Growth and Development in Central and Eastern Europe” (Moscow, Russia), 2016.

Membership: American Economic Association, Economic History Society, European Social Science History Society, Association for Slavic, East European, & Eurasian Studies, Danish Society for Economic and Social History

Professional Activity Before PhD

2007 – 2011, Senior Teacher, Ryazan branch of Moscow State Open University

2002 – 2007, Teacher, Ryazan State Agricultural Academy

2000 – 2002, Teacher, Ryazan Oil-Chemical College

Languages

Russian (native), English (fluent)